

» 26 MAJOR EVENTS IN 2026

1) Hockey India League

The second edition of the Hockey India League (HIL) is being held across three cities – Chennai, Ranchi, and Bhubaneswar. The women's event with four teams is on till **January 10**, while the men's tournament with eight teams will run from **January 3 to January 26**.

***Ran Bengal Tigers, Men's champion**



2) Women's Premier League

The fourth edition of the WPL will be held at the DY Patil Stadium in Navi Mumbai and the Baroda Cricket Association Stadium in Baroda from **January 9-February 5**. The tournament will be played among five franchises and will be the first edition to follow a Mega Auction.

***Mumbai Indians**



3) ICC U-19 Men's World Cup



Zimbabwe and Namibia will co-host

the 16th edition from **January 15-February 6**. 16 teams will compete in the 50-over tournament, playing 41 matches across 23 days. The competition will feature a group stage, followed by the Super Six, before the top four teams qualify for the knockouts.

***Australia**



4) Australian Open

The first Grand Slam of the year will be held in Melbourne from **January 18-February 1**. Jannik Sinner and Madison Keys are the reigning champions.

***Jannik Sinner, Men's singles**

11) World Team Table Tennis Championships

This landmark edition – **April 28-May 10** in London – will mark 100 years since the inaugural tournament in 1926. 64 teams will compete in the Men's and Women's team events.

***China, Men's champion**



12) French Open

Roland-Garros, the second Grand Slam of the year, will be played in Paris from **May 24-June 7**. Carlos Alcaraz and Coco Gauff are the defending champions in the men's and women's singles categories.

***Carlos Alcaraz, Men's singles**



5) ICC Men's T20 World Cup



India and Sri Lanka will co-host the 10th edition from

February 7-March 8. A total of 55 matches will be played across eight venues – five in India and three in Sri Lanka. 20 teams will compete across three stages: Group Stage, Super 8s, and Knockouts.

***India**

10) Thomas & Uber Cup

Denmark will host the BWF Thomas & Uber Cup Finals in Horsens from **April 24-May 3**. 16 nations will compete in the biennial team-format event, marking only the fourth time in the tournament's 75-year history that it will be staged in Europe.

***China, Thomas Cup**



13) FIFA World Cup

The 23rd edition of football's marquee event will be the first to feature 48 nations and the first to be hosted jointly by three countries – the USA, Canada, and Mexico. From **June 11-July 19**.

***Argentina**



8) AFC Women's Asian Cup

India qualified for the continental tournament –

March 1-21 – for the first time on merit after an unbeaten qualification campaign. Placed in Group C alongside Japan, Vietnam, and Chinese Taipei, the Blue Tigresses will begin their campaign against Vietnam on March 4 in Australia.

***China**



6) Shooting League of India

The inaugural season of the Shooting League of India (SLI) will be held in New Delhi from **February 16-26**. The franchise-based competition will feature Pistol, Rifle, and Shotgun disciplines.

***Manu Bhaker (expected participant)**



7) Indian Premier League

The 19th edition of the IPL will be held across the country starting **March 26-May 31**. A total of 10 franchises will compete in the tournament lasting nearly two months.

***Royal Challengers Bengaluru**



9) FIDE Candidates

R. Praggnanandhaa will be the lone Indian in the men's Candidates tournament, competing for a place in the World Chess Championship match. The Women's Candidates will feature three Indians – Divya Deshmukh, Koneru Humpy, and R. Vaishali. In Cyprus from **March 28-April 16**.

***D. Gukesh**

